

**LISTENING
#38****Teacher's Guide****SCRIPT: BUDGET PLANNER**

Ron: Uh, could I borrow a few bucks until payday? I'm a little strapped for cash.

Nancy: Uh, yeah, I guess, but I'm pinching pennies myself, and you still owe me \$20 from last week. [Oh . . .] And mom and your friend Ron said that you borrowed money from them this past week. [Oh yeah.] And how ARE things going anyway?

Ron: Well, not very well. To be honest, I'm really in a hole, and I can't seem to make ends meet these days.

Nancy: What do you mean? I thought you landed a great job recently, so you must be loaded

Ron: Well, I do have a job, but I've used my credit cards to pay off a lot of things recently, but now, I can't seem to pay the money off.

Nancy: Uh, do you have a budget? I mean, how do you keep track of your income and expenses?

Ron: Well, when my money runs out, I come to you. Of course. [Great!] No, but I guess I should have some financial plan.

Nancy: Well, let's see if I can help you. How much money do you spend on your apartment?

Ron: Uh, I pay \$890 on rent for the studio apartment downtown . . . not including utilities and cable TV. But the place has an awesome view of the city.

Nancy: Uh, \$890! Why are you paying through the nose for such a small place when you could find a cheaper one somewhere outside of the downtown area?

Ron: Yeah, I guess.

Nancy: Okay. How much money do you spend on food a month?

Ron: Hmm. Well, I'm not really sure. I think I spend around \$600. [\$600?!] Well, I go out to eat at least four times a week, so the expenses add up. I just don't enjoy eating alone, and I don't have a knack for cooking like you do.

Nancy: Well, I can understand that, but perhaps you ought to buy some microwaveable meals you could just prepare at home.

Ron: Well, I guess I could.

Nancy: And entertainment?

Ron: Well, I spend a few dollars here and there on basketball and movie tickets, a concert or two, and ballroom dance lessons.

Nancy: Uh, exactly how much do you spend on all of these? Just a "few" dollars?

Ron: Well, oh . . . about \$400 or so.

Nancy: Or so? No wonder you're having money problems. You just can't blow your money on things like that! And what about transportation?

Ron: Well, I commute to work every day in my new sports car, but I got a great deal, and my monthly payments are only \$450 a month. Come outside and take a look. We can go for a spin!

Nancy: No, I've heard enough. You've got to curb your spending, or you'll end up broke. I suggest you get rid of your credit cards, [Aww . . .] cut back on your entertainment expenses, and sell your car. [Huh?] Take public transportation from now on.

Ron: Sell my car?! I can't date without a car. What am I gonna [going to] say? "Uh, could you meet me downtown at the bus stop at 7:00?" Come on!

Nancy: And you need to create a budget for yourself and stick to it, and start with paying off your bills, starting with me. You owe me \$50 dollars.

Ron: Fifty dollars! Wait, I only borrowed \$20 from you last week. How did you come up with \$50?

Nancy: Financial consulting fees. My advice is at least worth \$30!

Audio Comprehension Questions:

1. b) He does not have enough money until payday.
2. He already owes her money and has borrowed from other people.
3. He has been using credit cards and cannot pay them off.
4. b) He asks the woman to lend him some.
5. \$890 a month.
6. He goes out to eat at least four times a week because he does not enjoy eating alone and does not know how to cook very well.
7. Basketball games, movies, concerts, and dance lessons.
8. She recommends getting rid of his credit cards, cutting back on entertainment, selling his car, using public transportation, creating a budget, sticking to it, and paying off his bills.
9. She is including a fee for giving him financial advice.

Reading Comprehension Questions

1. His salary increased, so he decided to improve his lifestyle by moving into a more expensive apartment, buying a newer phone, and eating at restaurants more often.
2. The purchases were divided into monthly payments, so Lucas focused on each payment instead of the total amount he owed.
3. He canceled two subscriptions, started taking lunch to work, reduced his restaurant meals, sold furniture he did not need, and used the money to lower his credit card balance.

Idioms/Useful Expressions

“Strapped for cash” = temporarily having very little money

The man says: “I’m a little strapped for cash.”

“Make ends meet” = have enough money to pay for basic expenses

The man says: “I can’t seem to make ends meet these days.”

“Pay through the nose” = overpay, pay much more than something is worth

The woman says: “Why are you paying through the nose for such a small place?”

“Curb your spending” = control and reduce the amount of money you spend

The woman says: “You’ve got to curb your spending, or you’ll end up broke.”